

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

POLICY MANUAL

VOLUME 3

Policy: 302.01 Code of Safe Practices

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ELECTRICAL SAFETY

1. Check equipment, cords and attachments before each use to ensure they are safe to use and operate.
2. Keep electrical cords up and out of the way so that no one steps on the cords, a potential shock or fire hazard.
3. Report any damaged electrical equipment promptly to your immediate supervisor.
4. Make sure equipment is properly grounded and plugged into grounded circuits.
5. If flammable or corrosive chemicals are nearby, use extreme caution with electricity.
6. Follow procedures for operating electrical equipment in these areas.
7. Use lockout/tagout procedures and equipment to ensure that power is completely off during maintenance and repairs of hard-wired equipment.
8. Stay clear of energized parts whenever possible. If you must work with energized parts, always use protective equipment such as rubber gloves, sleeves, blankets, mats and nonconducting tools.
9. Keep conductive materials away from sources of electricity. Such materials include steel wool, metallic cleaning cloths and some chemical solutions.
10. Keep in place original equipment guards that protect electrical equipment.
11. Use only electrical equipment in wet or damp locations that is designed for such use. All electrical equipment in these areas must be grounded and the use of ground fault circuit interrupters (GFCI) is required.
12. Remove damaged equipment from service. Only use such equipment that you know is safe to use.
13. Keep electrical panel doors on and closed.
14. Keep access to electrical panels clear with at least a 36" clearance.
15. Ensure all circuit breakers in electrical panels are correctly labeled so you know which circuits to shut off in an emergency.
16. Attempt to plug electrical equipment directly into a nearby outlet so that electrical extension cords do not have to be used. Add additional electrical outlets as needed.
17. Rearrange furniture or install additional electrical outlets where the power is needed so that electrical cords do not have to be run across aisle ways.

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EYE AND FACE PROTECTION

Personal Protective Equipment

1. Always wear the correct eye and face protection if you work with: metals, liquid chemicals, hazardous gases, flying particles or injurious light rays.
2. Never rely on regular glasses or contact lenses to protect your eyes.
3. Where there is a specific requirement to wear safety glasses or goggles for complete eye protection, face shields by themselves are not permitted.
4. Wear safety glasses or goggles under face shields for added protection whenever possible.
5. Wear tinted or shaded lenses to protect you from glare when working in a bright environment.
6. Ask your supervisor if contact lenses are safe to wear for the kind of work that you are doing.
7. Always keep your safety eye protection equipment in good repair, replacing if scratched or cracked.
 - a. Keep lenses clean.
 - b. Keep goggles in a case or pouch when not in use.
8. Management ensure that:
 - a. Previously used equipment is disinfected before reissuing to another employee.
 - b. First-aid instructions are posted close to potential danger spots.

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FIRE SAFETY

1. Ensure good housekeeping is maintained, keeping work areas clean and free of debris.
2. Make sure all electrical equipment is protected.
3. Store flammable materials in approved safety cans and/or cabinets.
 - a. Keep smoking and flames/sparks away from areas where flammables are present.
 - b. Clean or report all spills of flammable liquids.
4. Maintain all electrical circuits so they do not become overloaded.
5. Use only space heaters that have:
 - a. An automatic "tip-over" device that shuts the unit off if the device should topple over.
 - b. Sufficient electrical power on the circuit to handle the space heater's electrical needs.
6. Keep fire exits and escape routes clear and well marked.
7. Know the evacuation routes from your work area.
8. Know where alarm boxes are located.
9. Know the procedures for reporting fires and using fire extinguishers.
10. Know where fire extinguishers are located and what type to use on each kind of fire:
 - a. Type A: Wood, paper, cloth, rubbish
 - b. Type B: Flammable gas/liquids, oil, grease, oil-based paint
 - c. Type C: Electrical
 - d. Type D: Combustible metals
11. Maintain a fire watch at all times that open flames are present, and follow all safety precautions when welding, cutting and/or brazing.

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GENERAL SAFETY PRACTICES

The following practices are designed to help you work in a safe manner. All practices are to be followed. Managers and supervisors enforce them for the good and welfare of everyone.

1. No function of this organization is so critical as to justify or require a compromise of safety and health.
2. Learn everything you can about your job so you do each task in a safe manner.
3. Work at a pace whereby you get the job done in a timely manner without hurting yourself or fellow employees.
4. As time permits, keep your work area as clean as possible so you do not get hurt.
5. Take special care to watch where you are walking to avoid slipping or tripping and possibly falling.
6. Only use equipment and machines on which you have been trained to operate.
7. Bend your knees and use your legs to lift, push or pull objects.
8. Wear all the personal protective equipment appropriate for the work you are performing.
9. Take your job seriously and work diligently to ensure that you and everyone around you work in a safe manner. Ensure that safe performance matters in all that you do. Remember: Alcohol and illegal drugs are prohibited in the workplace.
10. Report immediately to your supervisor:
 - a. On-the-job injuries or illnesses.
 - b. Hazards, unsafe practices, or policies and procedures that you believe could cause an accident.

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GUARDING

Machine guards are meant to protect you from Injury :

1. When Operating Machines:

- a. Never remove or bypass a guard or other safety device.
- b. Never operate a machine if a guard is missing, modified or not working right.
- c. Make sure guards removed for maintenance are replaced and working right before operations resume.
- d. Never remove a guard to increase your productivity. If you believe a guard is making it hard for you to work efficiently, talk to your supervisor or organization manager. Don't sacrifice your safety to get a job done faster.
- e. Always keep guards in place to protect you from pinch points, crush points, amputation injuries and dangerous energy sources (electrical, mechanical, pneumatic, hydraulic, gravity, chemical or thermal) that can harm you.

2. Kinds of Guards:

- a. Enclosures - most common type
- b. Remote control
- c. Removal devices
- d. Two-handed tripping devices
- e. Interlocking devices
- f. Electronic safety devices
- g. Moving barriers

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HAND TOOLS

1. Basic Rules
 - a. Select the right tool for the job.
 - b. Inspect the tool and ensure the tool is in good condition.
 - c. Wear eye protection at all times.
 - d. Use the tool in the correct and safe way.
 - e. Concentrate your full attention on the task at hand.
 - f. Use tools in a professional manner; they are not toys.
 - g. After use, store the tool in a safe location.
2. Handsaws
 - a. Ensure all saws are sharp and properly set.
 - b. Select the proper saw for the material being cut.
 - c. Move the saw in a straight line, without twisting or binding.
 - d. Hold the material being cut firmly so that it will not bind or stick.
3. Hammers
 - a. Select the correct hammer for the job. Only soft hammers should be used to drive hardened drills or chisels or to adjust dies.
 - b. Hammer handles must fit tightly, and not have any cracks or splinters.
 - c. Grip the hammer handle near the end; do not choke the handle.
 - d. Look at the striking end of the hammer when delivering the blow, to avoid hitting your hand or fingers.
4. Punches, drills and chisels
 - a. Dress flat the ends of struck tools such as cold chisels, star drills, and punches.
 - b. Grind or file a small radius around the edge of the striking surface to reduce spilling and subsequent danger of flying steel chips.
5. Keep cutting edges sharp.
6. Use pliers or tongs to hold a tool and to avoid hand injury, where possible.

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HOUSEKEEPING

1. Arrange furniture and equipment so it is easy to use and move around.
2. Keep tables and shelving units from becoming overloaded.
3. Keep chairs squarely on the floor; make sure coasters are securely attached.
4. Check furniture comers for rough edges and sharp points. Try to keep comers round and smooth.
5. Store heavier items at waist level for ease of lifting.
6. Open one file or storage drawer at a time.
7. Turn off office machines when finished using them.
8. Keep electrical circuits from becoming overloaded. Request additional outlets and power if needed.
9. Check electrical cords for frayed or worn spots.
10. Keep electrical, telephone, computer and other cords out of aisle ways. The optimum approach is to rearrange furniture and/or install additional outlets where the power is needed.
11. Store sharp tools down and away. Use cardboard sheaths to cover such tools.
12. Keep all bottles and containers clearly labeled as to their ACTUAL contents.
13. Box and label supplies.
14. Keep a step stool or ladder on hand for reaching hard to reach objects.
15. Maintain good, sufficient lighting.
16. Clean up spills immediately.

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ILLUMINATION

1. Inspect your work place to identify areas that need improved illumination for more work efficiency, safety, and security.
2. Work only with protected light sources (no bare bulbs) wherever possible to reduce glare and improve focusing power; keep lighting needed for just your work area, shielded so that others are not bothered by direct light.
3. Keep bulbs and reflectors clean to reduce glare and eliminate shadows. Your work area should have direct light.
4. To improve work efficiency while doing computer work. Take one or more of the following actions that may help you reduce glare:
 - a. Dim office lights
 - b. Control brightness of the screen
 - c. Move the screen so that direct light doesn't shine on your eyes.
 - d. Install a glare reducer on the screen.
5. Stop, and adjust your eyes when entering an area that has reduced lighting.
6. If you work in a poorly lit area where you need to concentrate on detailed work, try to improve the illumination if possible. If it is not possible to do so, take periodic breaks from the detailed work and focus your eyes on distant objects to give your eyes a rest break.

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OFFICE SAFETY

1. Use extreme caution when using stairs; hold on to handrails as you descend or ascend.
2. Open doors slowly, other people may be on the other side of doors as you enter or leave.
3. Maintain an orderly and clean work environment:
 - a. Keep desk and file cabinet drawers closed when unattended.
 - b. Keep open only one filing cabinet drawer at a time.
 - c. Close drawers on desks when they are not being used.
 - d. Keep boxes and supplies out of aisles.
 - e. Keep cords out of aisles; strap or tape them to desks or walls.
 - £ Put office supplies away when finished with a specific task.
 - g. Dispose of food and drink after use to keep pests away from the office.
 - h. Wipe up spills.
4. Keep personal items (such as purses, umbrellas, jackets, sweaters) off the floor, and in drawers, closets or on coat racks to avoid creating tripping hazards.
5. Take note of unfamiliar people in the office environment. Report suspicious people to your supervisor,

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PORTABLE LADDER SAFETY

1. All ladders:

- a. Select the right ladder for the job.
 - i. The ladder should be tall enough so that you can reach the required objects without standing on the top or second-to-the-top rung/step of the ladder or putting the ladder on some other object to reach the required objects.
 11. The ladder should be made of a material that is conducive for the work to be performed, e.g., a wood or fiberglass ladder for working around electrical equipment rather than a metal ladder.
- b. Use ladders for only their intended purpose, i.e., climbing up and down.
- c. Maintain ladders in good condition. Ladders in disrepair should be either disposed or fixed.
- d. Before climbing any ladder, check its condition:
 - i. Nuts and bolts tight?
 11. Rungs secure?
 111. Spreaders working?
 - 1v. Safety feet working right?
- e. Always face the ladder when ascending or descending, holding on with both hands.
- f. While working and whenever possible, hold on to the ladder with one hand.
- g. Use a tool belt or a bucket attached to a hand line to pull tools up.
- h. The trunk of your body should not extend past the side of the ladder. Move the ladder if you have to reach outside of this area.
- l. Wear slip-resistant footwear.
- J. Keep the ladder rungs free of oil and grease.

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2. Step Ladders

- a. Make sure the spreaders are locked open before climbing.
- b. Place a ladder only where it is safe to do so. For example, it is not safe to put a ladder in front of doors opening toward the ladder unless the door is blocked open, locked or guarded.
- c. Keep at or below the second rung from the top.

3. Straight Ladders

- a. Use the 4 to 1 rule. Position the base of the ladder one foot out from the wall for every four feet of the ladder's height up to the support point. For example, the base of a 16-foot ladder should be four feet out from the wall.
- b. Place the base of the ladder so that the ladder will not slip.
- c. Ensure that the ladder extends at least 3 feet above the elevated surface to which you are climbing.
- d. Lash the ladder at the top to hold it in place.
- e. Adjust extension ladders while standing at the base, not while standing on the ladder or from a position above the ladder.
- f. Keep at or below the third rung from the top on a straight ladder.

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PORTABLE POWER TOOLS AND EQUIPMENT

1. Install Cal-OSHA required safety guards and shields on grinders, saws and similar equipment.
2. Equip circular saws with guards above and below the base shoe.
3. Check circular saw guards to assure they are not wedged up, leaving the lower portion of the blade unguarded.
4. Guard all rotating or moving parts of equipment, such as belts, pulleys, chains, and sprockets.
5. Effectively ground all cord-connected, electrically powered tools and equipment, or use double-insulated type tools.
6. Only use grounded tools in wet conditions.
7. Use ground-fault circuit interrupters (GFCI) on all temporary electrical 15 and 20 ampere circuits used during periods of construction and anywhere near water.
8. Use hoisting equipment for lifting heavy objects; ensure hoist ratings and characteristics are appropriate for the task.
9. Check regularly all pneumatic and hydraulic hoses on power-operated equipment for deterioration or damage. Replace if necessary.
10. Ensure portable fans have full guards or screens having openings of not more than 1/2 inches.

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SAFETY RESPONSIBILITIES FOR MANAGERS AND SUPERVISORS

1. No function of this organization is so critical as to justify or require a compromise of safety and health.
2. Maintain a safe and healthy work environment for all your employees.
3. Coach the new employee on what is required and expected.
4. Train all employees to be aware of the hazards in their work environment and to take appropriate action to prevent injury to themselves and others.
5. Enforce safety practices:
 - a. Recognize employees who comply regularly with the safety rules for their jobs.
 - b. Correct employees who do not comply. Provide discipline when needed.
6. Continually inspect your work areas to identify potential safety hazards or unsafe work practices.
7. Correct problems as quickly as possible after they are identified.
8. Keep aware of current and new occupational safety & health standards.
9. Obtain employee input to improve the safety effort.
- 10. Always set the safety example yourself.*

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SLIPS, TRIPS AND FALLS
Same Level

Avoid Slips, Trips and Falls By:

1. Looking before you walk; making sure your pathways are clear.
2. Wearing slip-resistant and well-fitted footwear.
3. Keeping materials off the floor.
4. Storing everything in its proper place.
5. Closing drawers immediately after each use.
6. Cleaning up debris, tools and equipment after each job.
7. Reporting accidental spills immediately.
8. Bundling and strapping wires, cords and cables together, and securing them up and out- of-the-way.
9. Posting WARNING signs to make sure others are aware of a slip or triphazard.
10. Inspecting the area around you for slip and trip hazards.
 - a. Correcting those problems that you can fix yourself.
 - b. Reporting those hazards that require funds or more skilled people and equipment to fix.
11. Carrying a flashlight when you know you will be working in an area with low lighting or where you will be walking where there is insufficient lighting.
12. Walk; don't run!

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PURPOSE

The purpose of the Illness and Injury Prevention Program (IIPP) is to ensure the health and safety of all employees, city staff, vendors and visitors at the Calimesa Fire Department.

SAFETY POLICY

We believe everyone benefits from a safe and healthy work environment. We are committed to maintaining a safe workplace and to complying with applicable laws and regulations governing safety.

To achieve this goal, the Calimesa Fire Department has adopted an Injury & Illness Prevention Program (IIPP). This program is everyone's responsibility as we work together to identify and eliminate conditions, practices, policies and procedures compromising safety.

To this end, each and every manager, supervisor and employee have the authority to take action to prevent mishaps.

It takes positive and genuine effort to assure a safe work environment. The alternative is wasted money and wasted time due to occupational injuries and illnesses and their associated pain and suffering.

Our expectations are everyone will:

1. Do the right thing the first time.
2. Seek to integrate safety into all tasks.
3. Avoid taking short cuts.
4. Take time to assure a safe workplace.
5. Have a safe and healthy work experience here at Calimesa Fire Department.